11.1 Living documentation: a high-level view

BDD reports don't simply provide a list of test outcomes, in terms of passing or failing tests. First and foremost, BDD reports document and describe what the application is expected to do, and they report whether or not the application actually performs these operations correctly. When you drill down into the details, a BDD report also illustrates *how* a particular feature or functionality is performed, from the user's perspective.

Living documentation targets a broad audience (see figure 11.1). You've seen how BDD encourages teams to collaborate to define acceptance criteria in the form of concrete examples, scenarios, and executable specifications, and how these guide the development and delivery of the features being built. As features are delivered, the living documentation ties the features back to the original requirements, confirming that what was delivered corresponds to what the team originally discussed.

In this way, BDD reporting completes the circle that started with the initial conversations with business stakeholders. The stakeholders, business analysts, testers, and anyone else that participated in the conversations leading up to the scenarios

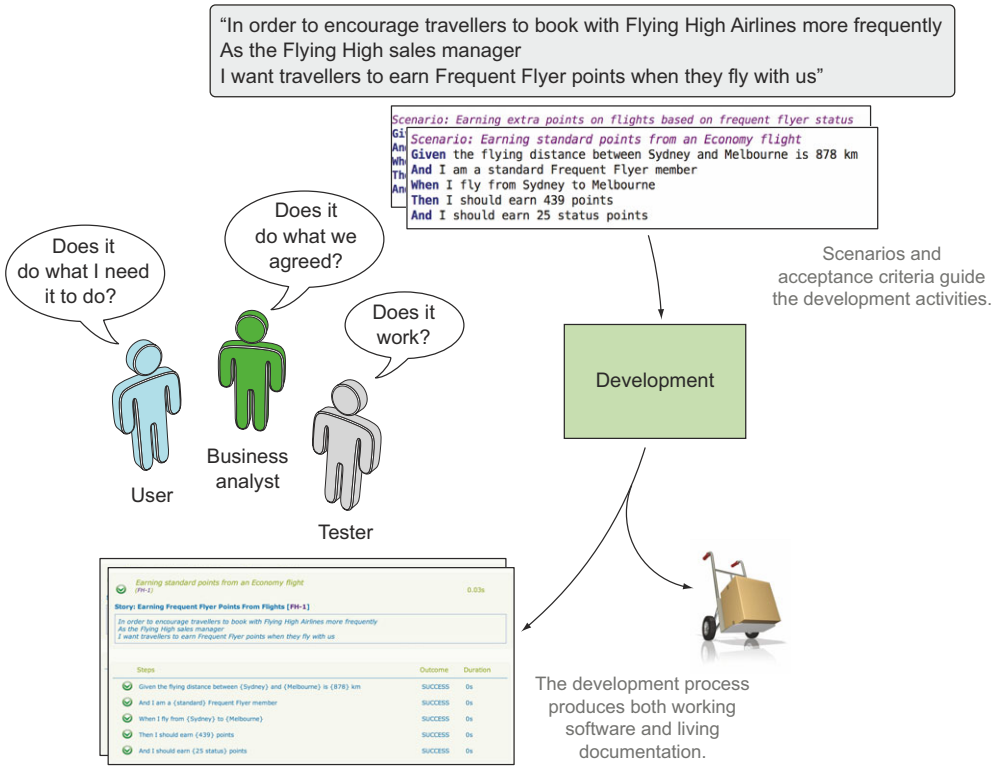


Figure 11.1 Living documentation provides feedback to the whole team, but in particular to business analysts, testers, and business stakeholders.